actually happened', 7 February 2018, https://www.indiatvnews.com/news/india-pm-modi-recalls-how-rajiv-gandhi-publicly-insulted-t-anjaiah-dalit-cm-of-andhra-pradesh-here-s-what-actually-happened-426523. For details of that incident, also see: Radhika Ramaseshan, 'Rajiv shadow in Rahul snub', *The Telegraph*, 29 March 2008.

37. Veerendra Patil interview with M.D. Nalapat, '"Liquor kings found me unreasonable": Patil', *The Times of India*, 2 December 1990.

38. Veerendra Patil interview with M.D. Nalapat, '"Elect leader democratically": Veerendra', *The Times of India,* 3 September 1991.

39. S.S. 'Caste and power game in Karnataka', *Economic & Political Weekly*, Vol. 25, No. 42/42, 20–27 October 1990.

40. James Manor in 2013 estimated Lingayats to be about 17 per cent of the population. James Manor, 'Lucky in its adversaries, a slipshod Congress gains a majority in the Karnataka election', *Economic & Political Weekly*, Vol. 48, No. 47, 23 November 2013, p. 54.

41. Personal interview with V. Anand, director, Octobuzz Analytics Pvt. Ltd., and in-charge of Yediyurappa's communications and social media campaign in the 2018 election, 9 February 2020, Bengaluru.

42. On this, see, for instance, Sandeep Shastri, B.S. Padmavathi, 'Karnataka: The lotus blooms … nearly', *Economic & Political Weekly*, Vol. 44, No. 6, 7–13 February 2009, p. 45.

43. In 2004, the Congress (35.28 per cent votes) significantly outpolled the BJP (28.49 per cent) but won only sixty-five seats compared to the BJP's seventy-nine. In 2008, again, the Congress won more votes (34.59 per cent) than the BJP (35.86 per cent), but won only eighty seats, compared to the BJP's 110. In 2018, the Congress won more votes (38.04 per cent) than the BJP (36.22 per cent), but underperformed on seats with seventy-eight, compared to the BJP's 104. 2004 and 2008 data quoted in James Manor, 'Letting a winnable election slip away: Congress in Karnataka', *Economic & Political Weekly*, Vol. 43, No. 41, 11–17 October 2008, p. 23. 2018 data from https://eci.gov.in/files/file/6933-karnataka-2018/.